Lankan military. The intelligence included the Tigers' military formations as well as civilian populations so as to avoid casualties.

'If it hadn't been for R&AW's technical support, the Sri Lankan army would not have defeated the LTTE,' said Avinash. 'The Tigers were better trained than many Sri Lankan army units. Besides training the LTTE's top leadership in India during the Indira Gandhi government, the Indian agents had helped raise massive infrastructure in Jaffna. The success of the LTTE's naval wing could be gauged from the fact that three swimming pools, each the size of a football stadium, had been created in Jaffna for underwater training. The depth of these pools was approximately one hundred metres.'

Even the CIA had acknowledged way back in 1986: 'LTTE is capable of fighting government troops without Indian support and probably would continue operations even if other groups agreed to a negotiated settlement. LTTE has developed a disciplined fighting force of about 3,000 members and may be training some of its cadres in Nicaragua and Cuba.'

Avinash thought the CIA's assessment was wrong. He said the LTTE cadres had been made battle-hardened in the jungles of Uttar Pradesh and while they may have received arms and ammunition from abroad, their skills had been earned in India.

According to Avinash, there had been two factions in the R&AW during the 1980s: one supported the LTTE and their demand for a separate Eelam and the other opposed any kind of meddling in Sri Lanka's internal affairs.

'The group in support of the LTTE was much stronger and that was why we decided to support the insurgents at the cost of